
tmux Cheat Sheet

Sessions, windows, panes, and copy mode — the whole multiplexer at a glance.

GitHub ↗

The **prefix** is `Ctrl+b` by default. Press the prefix, release it, then press the next key — it's two separate keystrokes, not a chord.

SHELL typed at your regular shell prompt **PREFIX** `Ctrl+b`, release, then this key

IN COPY MODE typed once you're already inside copy mode — no prefix

SESSIONS

SHELL

Typed directly at the shell, before or outside tmux.

COMMAND	ACTION
<code>tmux</code>	Start a new session.
<code>tmux new -s [session_name]</code>	Create a new session with a specific name.
<code>tmux attach</code>	Re-attach to the latest active session.
<code>tmux detach</code>	Disconnect from a session, but keep it running.
<code>tmux attach -t [session_name]</code> <code>/ tmux a -t [session_name]</code>	Attach to a session with a specific name.
<code>tmux switch -t [session_name]</code>	Switch to a different session.
<code>tmux rename-session -t [old_name] [new_name]</code>	Rename an existing session.
<code>tmux list-sessions / tmux ls</code>	List all active tmux sessions.
<code>tmux kill-session -t [session_name]</code>	Terminate a specific session.
<code>tmux kill-session -a</code>	Kill all sessions but the current one.
<code>tmux kill-session -a -t [session_name]</code>	Terminate all sessions except the specified one.
<code>tmux kill-server</code>	Terminate the tmux server, ending all sessions, windows, and panes.

WINDOWS

PREFIX

Think of windows as tabs — each one full-screen until you split it into panes.

SHORTCUT	ACTION
Ctrl+b then c	Create a new window.
Ctrl+b then ,	Rename the current window.
Ctrl+b then w	List all windows.
Ctrl+b then &	Kill the current window.
Ctrl+b then n	Switch to the next window.
Ctrl+b then p	Switch to the previous window.
Ctrl+b then l	Open the last window.
Ctrl+b then 0....9	Switch to a specific numbered window.
Ctrl+b then d	Detach from the current session.

PANES

PREFIX

Splits within a window.

SHORTCUT	ACTION
Ctrl+b then %	Split the current pane vertically.
Ctrl+b then "	Split the current pane horizontally.
Ctrl+b then x	Close the current pane.
Ctrl+b then o	Switch between panes.
Ctrl+b then z	Toggle pane zoom (make pane full screen).
Ctrl+b then ;	Toggle between the last two active panes.
Ctrl+b then {	Move the current pane left.
Ctrl+b then }	Move the current pane right.
Ctrl+b then Space	Toggle through different pane layouts.
Ctrl+b then !	Convert the current pane into a window.
Ctrl+b then q	Display pane number.
Ctrl+b then ↑	Increase pane height.
Ctrl+b then ↓	Decrease pane height.
Ctrl+b then ←	Increase pane width.
Ctrl+b then →	Decrease pane width.

COPY MODE

PREFIX

+ IN COPY MODE

Uses vi-style navigation by default. Enter and paste need the prefix; once you're inside copy mode, the movement and selection keys don't.

ENTER / PASTE (PREFIXED)

SHORTCUT	ACTION
Ctrl+b then [	Enter copy mode.
Ctrl+b then]	Paste the copied text.

INSIDE COPY MODE (NO PREFIX)

KEY	ACTION
q	Exit copy mode.
Space	Start text selection in copy mode.
Enter	Copy the selected text.
Esc	Clear the selected text and exit copy mode.
h	Move the cursor left.
j	Move the cursor down.
k	Move the cursor up.
l	Move the cursor right.
w	Move the cursor one word forward.
b	Move the cursor one word backward.
Ctrl+u	Scroll up half a page.
Ctrl+d	Scroll down half a page.
PgUp	Scroll up full page.
PgDn	Scroll down full page.



Ctrl+b is a stretch. Most people remap the prefix to `Ctrl+a` (screen muscle memory) or `Ctrl+Space`. In `~/.tmux.conf`: `unbind C-b`, `set -g prefix C-a`, `bind C-a send-prefix`.

Reference source: [phoenixNAP — tmux Cheat Sheet](#)